

What You Should Complete First (Actual Development Start)

CURRENT TARGET = Phase 1 + Beginning of Phase 2

By tomorrow, try to complete these:

TASK 1 — Create Main Project Folder

research-project-support-system/

```
|  
|— frontend/  
|— backend/  
└— README.md
```

TASK 2 — Create GitHub Repository

Push initial structure.

Commands:

```
git init
```

```
git add .
```

```
git commit -m "Initial project structure"
```

Then connect GitHub repo.

TASK 3 — Setup Backend

Inside backend folder:

```
npm init -y
```

Install packages:

```
npm install express cors dotenv pg
```

TASK 4 — Create Simple Backend Server

Create:

```
backend/server.js
```

Code:

```
const express = require("express");
```

```
const app = express();
```

```
app.get("/", (req, res) => {  
  res.send("Research Project Support Backend Running");  
});
```

```
app.listen(5000, () => {  
  console.log("Server running on port 5000");  
});
```

Run:

```
node server.js
```

If browser shows:

Research Project Support Backend Running

✅ backend works.

TASK 5 — Setup Frontend

Inside frontend folder:

```
npx create-react-app .
```

Start frontend:

```
npm start
```

If React page opens:

✅ frontend works.

TASK 6 — First Proper Commit

After both run successfully:

```
git add .
```

```
git commit -m "Setup frontend and backend locally"
```

```
git push
```

What You Will Have Achieved

By completing this, your project officially starts.

You will have:

- professional folder structure,

- GitHub workflow,
- frontend running,
- backend running,
- initial architecture,
- local development environment.

That is REAL software development progress.

First make sure:

- ✓ frontend works
- ✓ backend works
- ✓ GitHub works
- ✓ local environment works